

Ideation Phase

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template

Date	03 Oct. 2026
Team ID	SWTID-2026-8365
Project Name	Import Data using Transform Maps – ServiceNow Employee Data Import
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template:

Brainstorming provides a free and open environment that encourages everyone within a team to participate in the creative thinking process that leads to problem solving. Prioritizing volume over value, out-of-the-box ideas are welcome and built upon, and all participants are encouraged to collaborate, helping each other develop a rich amount of creative solutions.

Use this template in your own brainstorming sessions so your team can unleash their imagination and start shaping concepts even if you're not sitting in the same room.

Reference: <https://www.mural.co/templates/brainstorm-and-idea-prioritization>

Step-1: Team Gathering, Collaboration and Select the Problem Statement



Brainstorm & idea prioritization

Use this template in your own brainstorming sessions so your team can unleash their imagination and start shaping concepts even if you're not sitting in the same room.

🕒 10 minutes to prepare
🕒 1 hour to collaborate
👥 2-8 people recommended

Before you collaborate
A little bit of preparation goes a long way with this session. Here's what you need to do to get going.

🕒 10 minutes

A Team gathering
Define who should participate in the session and send an invite. Share relevant information or pre-work ahead.

B Set the goal
Think about the problem you'll be focusing on solving in the brainstorming session.

C Learn how to use the facilitation tools
Use the Facilitation Superpowers to run a happy and productive session.

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1 Define your problem statement
What problem are you trying to solve? Frame your problem as a How Might We statement. This will be the focus of your brainstorm.

🕒 5 minutes

PROBLEM

How might we [your problem statement]?

Key rules of brainstorming

To run an smooth and productive session

- Stay in topic.
- Defer judgment.
- Go for volume.
- Encourage wild ideas.
- Listen to others.
- If possible, be visual.

Project brainstorm: problem statement and goal

Team gathering	Project team members (add names): _____
Problem statement	How might we import bulk employee data from Excel into ServiceNow accurately and without duplicates, and turn it into reports the team can use?
Goal of the session	Generate ideas for loading, mapping, validating, updating and reporting on employee data using Import Sets and Transform Maps, then choose the ideas to build.
Rules followed	Stay on topic. Defer judgment. Go for volume. Encourage wild ideas. Listen to others.

Step-2: Brainstorm, Idea Listing and Grouping

2

Brainstorm
Write down any ideas that come to mind that address your problem statement.
⌚ 10 minutes

TIP

You can select a sticky note and hit the pencil (switch to sketch) icon to start drawing!

Amar

Yuktresh

Person 3

Person 4

Person 5

Person 6

Person 7

Person 8

3

Group ideas
Take turns sharing your ideas while clustering similar or related notes as you go. In the last 10 minutes, give each cluster a sentence-like label. If a cluster is bigger than six sticky notes, try and see if you can break it up into smaller sub-groups.
⌚ 20 minutes

Person 4

TIP

Add customisation tags to sticky notes to make it easier to find, remove, organise, and categorise important ideas as themes within your mind.

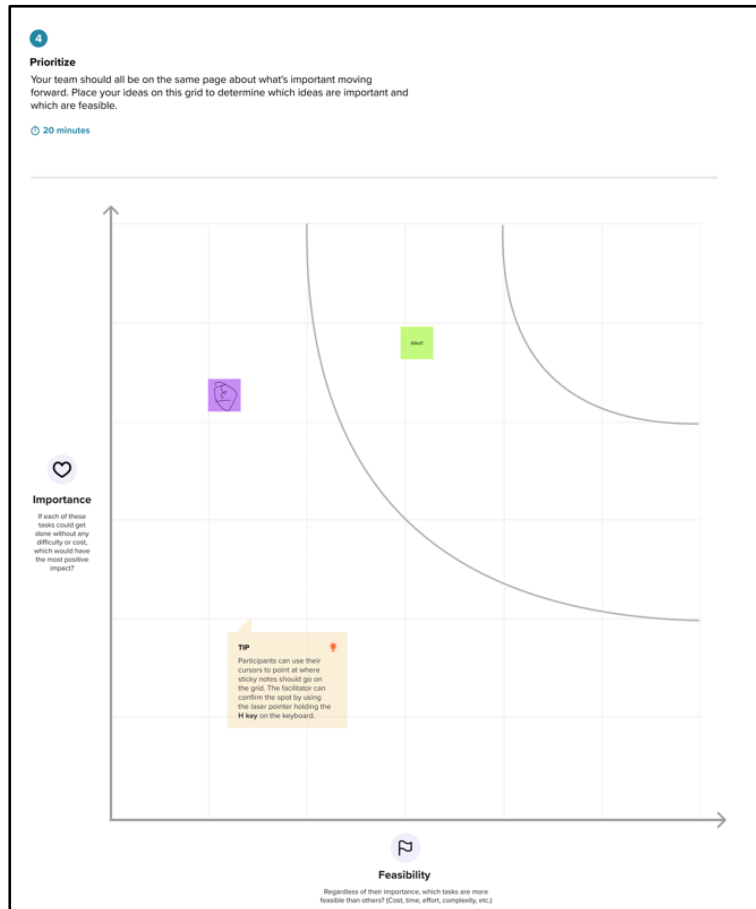
Brainstormed ideas, grouped into themes

Each idea below came from the team's brainstorming. Similar ideas were clustered and each cluster was given a short label.

Theme (idea group)	Ideas written on sticky notes
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Theme (idea group)	Ideas written on sticky notes
A. Load and stage the data safely	• Download the Google Sheet as .xlsx • Use Load Data to create the staging table u_employee_import • Keep the header row so columns become fields • Check the loaded data before transforming
B. Map fields correctly	• Create the target table u_employee_test with 5 String fields • Use Auto Map Matching Fields • Fix any mismatch with Mapping Assist
C. Prevent duplicates and keep data current	• Turn on Coalesce for Employee ID • Update changed names and emails instead of inserting • Re-import the same sheet: zero inserts and updates
D. Improve data quality	• Transform script to standardise Department (Servicenow to ServiceNow) • Choice lists for Department and Location • Email format validation • Enforce mandatory fields in the Transform Map
E. Verify the result	• Check Transform History (total, inserts, updates, ignored, errors) • Read the Import log for errors • Open Employee Tests and compare the record count
F. Visualise the data	• Pie chart: Employees by Department • Bar chart: Employees by Location • List report with all employee fields • One Employee Analytics Dashboard
G. Future automation	• Scheduled import from a data source (SFTP, JDBC or REST) • Notification when an import fails • Map employees to the sys_user table

Step-3: Idea Prioritization



Idea prioritization: importance vs feasibility

The team placed each idea on the grid by asking two questions. Importance: which idea has the most positive impact? Feasibility: which idea is easiest in cost, time, effort and complexity?

Ideas in the top-right area were chosen first.

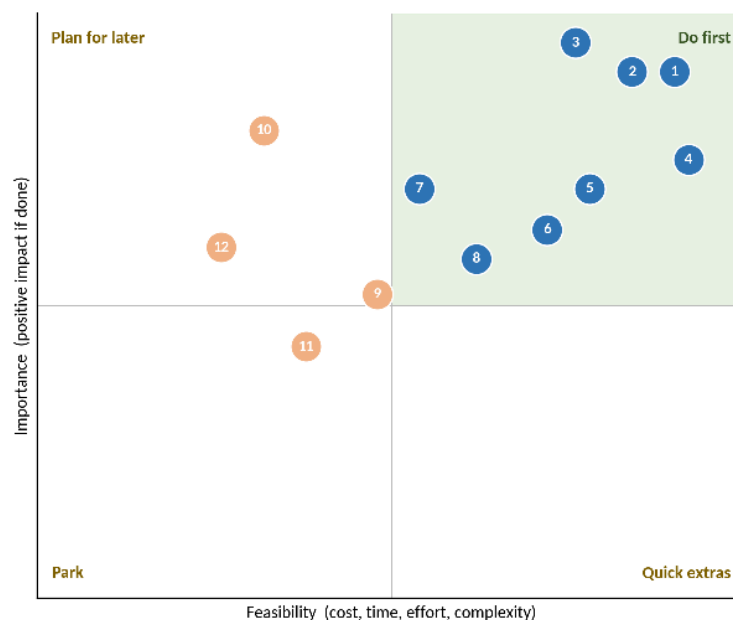


Figure: Prioritization grid (numbers match the table below).

#	Idea	Importance	Feasibility	Decision
1	Load the Excel file with Load Data into u_employee_import	High	High	Do first (implemented)
2	Transform Map with Auto Map Matching Fields	High	High	Do first (implemented)
3	Coalesce on Employee ID	High	High	Do first (implemented)
4	Verify with Transform History	High	High	Do first (implemented)
5	Reports: pie, bar and list	High	High	Do first (implemented)
6	Employee Analytics Dashboard	Medium	High	Do first (implemented)
7	Script to standardise Department values	High	Medium	Next improvement
8	Choice lists for Department and Location	Medium	Medium	Next improvement
9	Email format validation	Medium	Medium	Next improvement
10	Scheduled import from a data source	High	Low	Future scope
11	Failure notification	Low	Low	Future scope
12	Map employees to the sys_user table	Medium	Low	Future scope

Outcome: Ideas 1 to 6 were selected and built in this project: Load Data, Transform Map, Coalesce on Employee ID, Transform History checks, three reports and the Employee Analytics Dashboard. Ideas 7 to 12 are kept as future improvements.